

## GUIDE

# VA Loan Quick-Start Guide

My Grate Mortgage Guide · 7 min read

If you've served, the VA loan is one of the most powerful benefits you've earned — and one of the most misunderstood. Here's a clear, no-jargon start so you can use it with confidence.

## Who's eligible

Eligibility generally extends to qualifying veterans, active-duty service members, certain members of the National Guard and Reserves, and some surviving spouses. Eligibility is confirmed with a Certificate of Eligibility (COE) — we can help you request it.

## Why it's such a strong benefit

- **\$0 down payment** on eligible purchases, up to your entitlement — a rare and valuable feature.
- **No monthly mortgage insurance**, unlike many low-down-payment loans, which can meaningfully lower your payment.
- **Competitive rates** and flexible qualifying guidelines.
- **Limits on certain closing costs** the VA won't let you be charged.

## Understanding the funding fee

Most VA loans include a one-time VA funding fee that helps keep the program running for future borrowers. The amount varies based on factors like your down payment and whether it's your first use. It can usually be rolled into the loan rather than paid out of pocket.

Importantly, some borrowers — for example, those receiving compensation for a service-connected disability — may be exempt from the funding fee. We'll help you find out where you stand.

**Questions? Call or text (323) 313-8761**

Your loan officer: Anthony "Tony" Pelayo · NMLS #1501920

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The VA loan isn't a one-time benefit — many borrowers use it more than once over a lifetime.

## Using it more than once

Your VA entitlement can often be restored and reused — for instance, after you sell a home and pay off the prior VA loan. In some cases borrowers even have more than one VA loan at a time. The rules around entitlement are specific, so it's worth a conversation to map out your situation.

## How to start

1. Confirm eligibility and request your COE.
2. Get pre-approved so you know your budget and can shop confidently.
3. Find your home and let us guide the rest.

Thank you for your service — let's put your benefit to work. Reach out and we'll walk you through every step.

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